TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Respond to a Colleague's Idea You Don't Fully Agree With

Express Opinion | OREO | Opinion Exchange

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Respond to a colleague's idea: say one good point in it, give your different view with one reason and one example, and answer one concern politely.

WHO	You work in a small company in Johor Bahru with a showroom. About 60 customers buy there every day, and about 15 of them pay cash.
SITUATION	At Monday's meeting, Kumar suggests an idea: no more cash at the showroom, only e-wallet or card. E-wallets are faster, and nobody needs to count cash for 30 minutes every evening.
NEED	You like part of his idea, but not all of it. Most of the cash customers are older shop owners who come every week. Kumar asks what you think. Then Mr. Tan asks you too.
GOAL	Say one good point in Kumar's idea, give your view with one reason and one example, and answer one concern politely without giving up your view.

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Kumar asks: "I have an idea: no more cash at the showroom, only e-wallet or card. It's much faster! What do you think?" Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Mei Ling's answer. Mark where each part starts.

You're right that e-wallets are faster, Kumar, but I don't think we should stop taking cash completely. The main reason is that some of our regular customers don't use e-wallets. For example, about 15 of our 60 customers a day still pay cash, and most of them are shop owners who come every week. So I still think we should keep cash, at least for these customers.

O GOOD POINT · MY VIEW

R REASON

E EXAMPLE

O MY VIEW AGAIN

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Siti wants a snack corner. Everyone pays RM10 a month. Put Ali's answer in order: O → R → E → O.

- [ ] That's why I still feel it isn't fair for everyone to pay the same RM10.
- [ ] A snack corner is a nice idea, Siti, but I don't think everyone should pay RM10 a month.
- [ ] This is because some of us are not in the office much.
- [ ] For instance, Kumar is out at customers' shops four days a week.

Write the letter: **O** = Good point · my view · **R** = Reason · **E** = Example · **O** = My view again

SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

SAY ONE GOOD POINT FIRST

- [ ] You're right that …, but …
- [ ] I see your point about …, but …
- [ ] It's true that …, but …
- [ ] I agree that …, but …

GIVE YOUR VIEW

- [ ] I don't think we should …
- [ ] I'm not sure about …
- [ ] I think it's better to …
- [ ] For me, …

GIVE A REASON AND AN EXAMPLE

- [ ] The main reason is that …
- [ ] This is because …
- [ ] For example, …
- [ ] For instance, every week …

SAY YOUR VIEW AGAIN

- [ ] So I still think …
- [ ] That's why I feel …
- [ ] So overall, …

ACKNOWLEDGE A CONCERN AND RESPOND

- [ ] I understand, but …
- [ ] That's a fair point, but … / However, …
- [ ] Good point. I'll check and tell you by …

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. Kumar's idea saves time. [for example, / because / but] I don't think we should stop taking cash completely.

   _____

2. I'm not sure about the idea. [so / because / but] About 15 customers a day still pay cash.

   _____

3. Many regular customers don't use e-wallets. [because / but / so] We need to keep cash.

   _____

4. E-wallets are faster. [For example, / That's why / However,] Some older customers don't have one.

   _____

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. I _____ we should stop taking cash. (An opinion now)
   - ○ not think
   - ○ don't think
   - ○ doesn't think
2. About 15 customers _____ cash every day. (Something that happens every day)
   - ○ pays
   - ○ pay
   - ○ paying
3. Counting the cash _____ thirty minutes every evening. (A fact about one thing)
   - ○ taking
   - ○ take
   - ○ takes
4. Some older customers _____ go to another shop. (Possible, not certain)
   - ○ mights
   - ○ might to
   - ○ might

SLIDE 09 Agree in part · might

Say the part you agree with, then but and your view. Although at the start means the same as but. Use might or may for something possible, not certain.

E-wallets are **faster than** cash, **but** not everyone has one.

Although e-wallets are faster, some customers don't use them.

Some regular customers **might** stop coming.

Older customers **may** need more time.

SLIDE 10

Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

O GOOD POINT · MY VIEW

You're right that …, but I don't think …

R REASON

The main reason is that …

E EXAMPLE

For example, …

O MY VIEW AGAIN

So I still think …

SLIDE 11

Opinion Exchange

Your partner says a colleague's idea. You answer: one good point, your view, one reason, one example, your view again. Your partner fills the note, gives one concern, and you answer it.

1. Quiet minute: circle ONE reason and ONE example. Round 1 (3:00 each): say your card number; your partner says the idea.
2. Answer: good point, view, reason, example, view again. Partner: fill the note, ask for any empty line, give the concern.
3. Answer the concern in 1–2 sentences. Swap. New partner (line B moves a seat). Round 2 (2:00 each): same card, shorter.
4. New partner again. Round 3 (1:00 each), frames closed: workbook turned over. Same card, no concern.

Card 1 · The annual dinner night

Card 2 · Visit reports

Card 3 · The company trip

Card 4 · Computer passwords

Listener's note

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Card no. · good point			
Their view + reason			
Example: number, time			
View again at the end?			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Mr. Tan asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. But counting cash takes thirty minutes every evening. Isn't that a waste of time?
2. Some shops in JB don't take cash now. Why can't we do the same?
3. But only 15 of our 60 customers pay cash. Is that really a problem?

Start with: **That's true, but … · I understand. However, I still think … · Good point. I'll check and tell you by …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

Your brother wants a hotel buffet for your mother's 70th birthday, so nobody has to cook: RM120 a person, 30 relatives. Your mother eats very little and likes to be at home. Say one good point, then your view, one reason and one example.

That's a nice idea, but … · The main reason is that … · For example, … · So I still think …

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Says one good point in the colleague's idea before giving a different view.
- [ ] Gives one reason and one example (a number, a day or a time) for that view.
- [ ] Says their own view again at the end.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Good point first	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Reason + example	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
View again at the end	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · The annual dinner night

You are Siti. Say: 'Let's have the annual dinner on a Saturday night this year, so nobody has to rush from work. What do you think?' Fill the note. Then say: 'But won't people be tired?'

Card 2 · Visit reports

You are Kumar. Say: 'Let's write a report on every customer visit the same day, so nothing is forgotten. What do you think?' Fill the note. Then say: 'What if Mr. Tan asks about a visit on Tuesday?'

Card 3 · The company trip

You are Mei Ling. Say: 'Let's go to Langkawi for three days for the company trip. Everyone needs a real holiday. What do you think?' Fill the note. Then say: 'Isn't a short trip boring?'

Card 4 · Computer passwords

You are Ali. Say: 'Everyone should change their computer password every month, because it's safer. What do you think?' Fill the note. Then say: 'But what if someone finds out a password?'

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · The annual dinner night

Your view: Friday after work is better. · The restaurant is 10 minutes from the office · 11 of the 20 staff have young children · At 6 on a Friday, everyone is already in town · Weekends are family time for many

Card 2 · Visit reports

Your view: one report every Friday is enough. · You make about 12 customer visits a week · Each report takes about 15 minutes · You get back to the office at about 5.30 · Most visits are regular customers with the same order

Card 3 · The company trip

Your view: two days in Desaru is better. · The trip fund is RM500 a person · Desaru is 1.5 hours by car · Flights and hotel for Langkawi: about RM900 a person · Some staff can't be away from their children for long

Card 4 · Computer passwords

Your view: a new password every three months is enough. · 20 staff · After each change, about 5 people forget it and call Ali · Ali has 10 new laptops to set up this month · Many write the new password on paper on their desk